

Subject Code	ENGL5043
Subject Title	Advanced English Literature
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	n/a
Objectives	The subject aims to give students an opportunity to deepen their knowledge of the major genres and theories of English literature. It will cover selected texts of English language poetry, prose, and drama, encompassing both adult and children's literature, from three distinct literary periods. Primary texts will be complemented with historical context and readings in literary theory, providing students with the materials and techniques to conduct their own literary analyses. In addition to gaining subject knowledge, this analytical work combined with the experience of close reading, background study, and exploration of literary theory will enhance students' all-roundedness, cultural awareness, and critical thinking skills.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a. Read complex literary texts in English from both adult and children's literature with fluency and deep understanding of their content with a view to developing a life-long reading habit; b. Apply advanced analytical techniques to a variety of literary text types thereby enhancing critical understanding; c. Achieve deeper insights into the socio-historical and cultural backgrounds of the creators of the texts and how this background impacts on the text type, style, and content; d. Develop pedagogical or other professional applications for the study of literature and language arts.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	1. Poetry Advanced analysis of 19th to 21st century poetic texts 1.1 Understanding poetic forms and styles 1.2 Recognition of poetic devices and imagery 1.3 Exploring levels of interpretation 2. Prose Advanced analysis of a 19th-21st century novel 2.1 Understanding the socio-historic context of the novel 2.2 Analysing the structure of the novel 2.3 Exploring the characterization 2.4 Exploring the themes and how they are presented 3. Drama Advanced analysis of a 19th-21st century play 3.1 Understanding the socio-historic context of the play

	3.2 Analysing the dramatic structure 3.3 Exploring the characterization 3.4 Exploring the themes and how they are presented																																												
Teaching/Learning Methodology	Teaching will take place in interactive seminars with input from the teacher complemented with break-out discussion groups. Seminars and readings will be supplemented with video-viewings (e.g. film adaptations) and independent research.																																												
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	<table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="4">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed</th></tr> <tr> <th>a</th><th>b</th><th>c</th><th>d</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>1. Participation</td><td>10%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr> <tr> <td>2. Reading responses</td><td>20%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr> <tr> <td>3. Critical literary analysis essay</td><td>40%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr> <tr> <td>4. Group presentation</td><td>30%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr> <tr> <td>Total</td><td>100 %</td><td colspan="4"></td></tr> </tbody> </table> All assessments are designed to demonstrate students' ability to read critically and understand the texts involved, to show an understanding of the cultural period that produced them, and to analyse them using appropriate techniques. Each assessment will also be treated as an opportunity to explore professional/pedagogical applications.					Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed				a	b	c	d	1. Participation	10%	✓	✓	✓	✓	2. Reading responses	20%	✓	✓	✓	✓	3. Critical literary analysis essay	40%	✓	✓	✓	✓	4. Group presentation	30%	✓	✓	✓	✓	Total	100 %				
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Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:																																												
	▪ Seminars				39 Hrs.																																								
	Other student study effort:																																												
	▪ Extensive reading				44 Hrs.																																								
	▪ Assignments				43 Hrs.																																								
	Total student study effort				126 Hrs.																																								
Reading List and References	Required Reading: A selection of literary texts and scholarly background reading to be negotiated between instructor and students. References: Baldick, C. (2015). <i>The Oxford dictionary of literary terms</i> (4th ed.). OUP. Birch, D. (ed.) (2009). <i>The Oxford companion to English literature</i> (7th ed.). OUP.																																												

	Carey, G. (2006). <i>A multicultural dictionary of literary terms</i>. Jefferson, NC: McFarland & Co. Drury, J. (2005). <i>The poetry dictionary</i> (2nd ed.). Writer's Digest Press. Greenblatt, S. (ed.) (2024). <i>The Norton anthology of English literature</i> (11th ed.). New York: W.W. Norton & Co. Hayot, E. (2014). <i>The elements of academic style: Writing for the humanities</i>. Columbia University Press. Henry, L. (1995). <i>The fiction dictionary</i>. Cincinnati, Ohio: Story Press. Nelson, G. & Greenbaum, S. (2018) <i>An introduction to English grammar</i> (4th ed.) Essex, England: Longman. Leech, G. N. & Short, M. (2007). <i>Style in fiction: A linguistic introduction to English fictional prose</i> (2nd ed.). Harlow; New York: Longman. Murphy, B. (ed.) (2008). <i>Benet's reader's encyclopedia</i> (5th ed.). New York: Harper Collins Publishers.
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Prepared by Dr Tobias Lee in August 2025